



Harvard sues to stop freeze on funding

School accuses Trump of trying to gain leverage over academic decisions

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA AND DANIELE DOUGLAS-GABRIEL

Harvard University sued the Trump administration in federal court Monday, the latest move in the escalating feud between the nation's wealthiest school and the White House.

The lawsuit, filed in U.S. District Court in Massachusetts against multiple federal agencies, seeks to block the Trump administration from withholding federal funding "as leverage to gain control of academic decision making at Harvard."

Alan M. Garber, the president of Harvard, said in a message to the university community Monday that the Trump administration's actions are unlawful and beyond the government's authority.

Although some members of the administration have said their letter of demands sent this month was issued by mistake, Garber said, other statements and actions suggest otherwise: In addition to a freeze of \$2.2 billion in federal funding, the government has considered taking steps to freeze an additional \$1 billion in grants, initiated numerous investigations of Harvard's operations, threatened the education of international students and said that it is considering a revocation of Harvard's tax-exempt status.

Garber noted that the government has cited the university's response to antisemitism as a justification for its actions.

"As a Jew and as an American, I

SEE HARVARD ON A7

How OPM undercut '5 things' emails

From start, agency called Musk's order voluntary; now it's a joke to many

BY HANNAH NATANSON, FAIZ SIDDIQUI AND EMILY DAVIES

When Elon Musk and President Donald Trump commanded all federal workers to submit weekly emails listing five accomplishments, they warned of harsh consequences: Failure to comply would count as a resignation. Musk called the emails an accountability measure needed to ensure that staff even had a "pulse."

But records obtained by The Washington Post, as well as interviews with three dozen managers and employees across government, reveal that officials refused to comply with core aspects of the directive from the beginning.

In a briefing for top human resources officers across government held just two days after Musk's directive went out to all federal employees on Feb. 22, the Office of Personnel Management

SEE DOGE ON A5

Immigrant data: DOGE is granted access to Justice Dept. system. A3

Pope Francis dies at 88

HE CHANGED CHURCH'S APPROACH, IF NOT ITS DOCTRINE



STEFANO SPAZIANI/PICTURE-ALLIANCE/DPA/AP

Pope Francis, the first Latin American and first Jesuit to occupy the Throne of Saint Peter, greets a Vatican crowd on Christmas Day 2021. His papacy began in March 2013 after the historic retirement of his predecessor, and ended Monday after a respiratory illness.

A papacy of humility, warmth and mercy

BY ANTHONY FAIOLA

VATICAN CITY — Three days after white smoke billowed from the chimney of the Sistine Chapel in March 2013, the former archbishop of Buenos Aires greeted the international press inside a cavernous Vatican audience hall. As he rose from a richly upholstered armchair, a pair of well-worn black shoes peeked out from underneath his new papal robes.

The decision by Pope Francis, born Jorge Mario Bergoglio, to reject the lavish red slippers of his office was widely interpreted as a small act of rebellion in the tradition-bound Vatican.

The Argentine Jesuit had assumed the mantle of a church dazed by the abdication of Pope

Benedict XVI and wounded by revelations of rampant sexual abuse in the priesthood and financial scandal. Now, after the surprise selection of the first non-European pontiff since 741, Francis was demonstrating modestly but unmistakably that he would be a different kind of pope.

Francis, 88, died Monday of cerebral stroke and cardiocirculatory collapse, the Vatican announced. In February, after a bout with bronchitis, he had been hospitalized in Rome with what Vatican officials called a "complex clinical picture" that included a diagnosis of double pneumonia. Over recent years, he had suffered recurring respiratory infections, undergone colon and

abdominal surgery, and experienced increasing mobility problems, requiring the use of a cane and wheelchair.

His death came after Francis, ignoring doctors' orders to convalesce for two months and avoid large crowds, sought to continue his duties, making public appearances and holding private audiences before and during Easter. On Sunday, a day before his death, he met one-on-one with Vice President JD Vance and later funneled through a throng of 35,000 faithful in St. Peter's Square in the popemobile.

In Vatican City, regality was always part of the papal mystique. Yet after receiving the nod, Francis personally placed a call to

SEE POPE FRANCIS ON A8

POPE FRANCIS 1936-2025

His words often roiled polarized U.S. Catholics
The pope's inclusive style on LGBTQ issues drew the ire of conservatives. A4

A busy last day
Easter Mass, meeting with Vance and a final message. A11

Possible successors
Names to know as the church's cardinals prepare for a conclave. A13

D.C. community mourns
America's largest Catholic church honors "the pope of the people." B1

President stays in Hegseth's corner

Amid dysfunction in the Pentagon, the defense secretary remains defiant

BY DAN LAMOTHE

President Donald Trump on Monday dismissed a deepening controversy surrounding Pete Hegseth, declaring the embattled defense secretary is "doing a great job" despite seismic dysfunction within the Pentagon amid political infighting, numerous firings, and reports that he divulged to his wife, brother and lawyer the highly sensitive details of an imminent military operation.

The turmoil elicited a rebuke from at least one Republican lawmaker, who labeled the situation a "meltdown" and called into question how long Trump's affection for the increasingly isolated and defiant Cabinet pick will last. Pentagon officials have watched the unraveling of Hegseth's inner circle with alarm, concerned how



MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth, shown Monday at the White House, accused the media of publishing "a bunch of hit pieces."

it would function in a national security emergency and wondering whether the president may be forced to act.

"The president always expresses support for his team — right until he doesn't and you read about it in the tweet the next day," said one person familiar with

Trump's thinking, who, like others, spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the crisis.

Speaking outside the White House, Hegseth, a former Fox News personality and National Guard veteran, defended himself angrily. He lambasted the news

SEE HEGSETH ON A15

Retrieval of U.S. soldiers' bodies involved hundreds

Search for remains of 4 in Lithuanian bog was fraught with challenges

BY ALEX HORTON

The search party fanned out to scout for any sign of four American soldiers — and their 70-ton vehicle — who last month vanished in the night deep in the woods outside Pabrade, near Lithuania's border with Belarus.

It was 1st Sgt. Matthew Riley who discovered the tread marks that had gouged the soft earth along a firebreak trail. They led to a wet patch, barely 30 feet in diameter, but did not continue on the other side. Afloat on the surface was a soldier's satchel and a bottle of weapon lubricant.

There was a strong smell of fuel, but those who eyed the bog were skeptical something that

small could swallow such a massive armored vehicle. A soldier waded in up to their waist, but Riley was adamant: Someone had to dive down into the muck and be sure.

Over the next seven days, scores of people from four countries plumbed the muddy bog to locate and recover the missing men. The mission, fraught with extreme environmental and engineering challenges, was animated by risk and ingenuity — and a guiding belief in the military imperative that everyone must go home.

"We weren't leaving without our boys," Senior Chief Master Diver Carlos Hernandez, who led the U.S. Navy dive team on-site, told The Washington Post.

This account is based on interviews with more than a dozen individuals either involved with the operation or who knew the four soldiers who died in the March 25 tragedy: Staff Sgt. Jose

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Melania Trump hosted her first event since returning to the White House at Monday's Easter Egg Roll. C1

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